



YOU ARE **17 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

158 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Although the baby is lying on her side and the face cannot be seen, this image does show the leg and foot particularly well. Because 2D ultrasound only shows a “slice” of the baby, parts may appear to be missing, such as the arm here which stops midway.

“It’s normal and healthy for you to gain more weight in the second trimester of pregnancy than you did in the first trimester.”

While you may have gained little weight in the first trimester, from the second trimester onward you will gain weight each week. On average, women should put on 3–4lb per month from the second trimester to the end of pregnancy, though the weight gain tends to slow down in the last few weeks.

The amount of weight you should be gaining depends on many factors, not least your starting Body Mass Index (BMI) (see p.16). The target weight gains are detailed in the chart below.

Not all of the weight gained is the baby; in fact, the fetus makes up only a small part. The rest of the weight is accounted for by your growing uterus, amniotic fluid, breasts, and increased blood volume and fat (see [How much weight will you gain?](#)).

If you have any concerns about your weight, seek advice from your doctor. Your weight may not be checked routinely at your prenatal checkups, but your doctor will weigh you if she’s concerned about the amount of weight you’re gaining.

WEIGHT GAIN

Your target weight gain for the second trimester (as well as the third trimester) is 12–19lb. If, due to pregnancy discomforts, such as morning sickness, you had a difficult first trimester and did not gain much weight, this is a good time to increase your calories to make up some of the weight gain. If you gained too much weight in the first trimester, focus on staying active and filling your plate with lower-calorie yet nutrient-rich fruits and vegetables.

Keep your target weight gain in mind. The recommended total pregnancy weight gain is 25–35lb for women whose BMI (see p.16) is in the normal range, between 18.5 and 25.

If you were overweight at the start of pregnancy, your recommended weight gain is 11–20lb. Obese women should gain at least 11lb. If you started underweight, the recommended weight gain is 28–40lb. If you’re expecting twins, you should aim for a total gain of about 35–45lb.